



SATHWARO: TOGETHER, ADANI FOUNDATION AND ARTISANS STRIVE TO REVIVE INDIA'S ARTS & CRAFTS

“We were invisible. We didn’t have a voice until our work began to speak for us,” say Muslim women of the Bismi group of Jameelabad in Kottaikuppam panchayat of Ponneri taluka in Tamil Nadu.

Jameelabad in this southern state is a small village and home to the Muslim fishing community. The community faced hardships during the months when fishing is banned as they have no other source of income. Women, who rarely venture out of their homes, created small items from palm leaves in their spare time which hardly fetched them any money.

However, winds of change began to blow after the Adani Foundation started work in the region. The Foundation team tapped Bismi women’s talent and helped them form a self-help group (SHG) in July 2022. Soon after, the 14-member group began skill training. The Foundation also extended support in the form of materials worth Rs 70,000 under the livelihood enhancement project. The nimble fingers then began to create beautiful artefacts from palm leaves.

“We couldn’t believe our eyes that we could make shopping bags, lunch and chocolate boxes, mats, trays, etc., from the leaves abundantly available in our coastal village,” said Fathima. “We earned Rs 1,20,000 between July and September 2023,” she added excitedly. The new-found confidence has empowered the Bismi women, who are happy that they can contribute to their families’ income. They are the first in their village to start their own enterprise.

The Adani Foundation, the community support and engagement arm of the Adani Group, is dedicated to making strategic social investments to achieve sustainable outcomes throughout India. Since 1996, the Foundation has focused on core areas, including education, health, sustainable

livelihood, skill development and community infrastructure. With strategies based on national priorities and global Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), the Foundation is known for its innovative approach and focus on sustainability, which contributes to the well-being and wealth of

